# Project Report: Digital Literacy Portfolio

**Course Code:** CSE0001

**Course Title:** Digital Literacy

**Student Name:** Mayank Verma

**Registration Number:** 25BAI11069

**Branch:** B.Tech (AI & ML)

**Year:** First Year

**Institution:** VIT Bhopal University

**Date:** March 26, 2026

## Introduction

This project serves as a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio, developed as part of my role as a Student Digital Ambassador. The objective is to demonstrate proficiency across five key modules: visual communication, professional digital presence, coding collaboration, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness. By setting up a professional infrastructure on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, and researching critical safety topics like UPI fraud, I have built a foundation for navigating the digital landscape securely and professionally. This report documents the practical tasks completed and provides personal reflections on the digital tools and practices essential for a modern engineering student.

**Task 1 Reflection: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic**

For the first task of this project, I created a digital literacy awareness infographic using Canva. My design focuses on three critical areas for engineering students: safe internet practices, professional online presence, and effective email etiquette. I used a clean, professional template with icons to make the information easy to scan for my batchmates. One thing I found particularly interesting while making it was how many different elements go into "Digital Literacy" beyond just basic computer skills—it's really about how we conduct ourselves and stay safe in a connected world. The most difficult part was condensing the information to fit on a single page while keeping it visually appealing. This task helped me realize that as a Student Digital Ambassador, visual communication is just as important as technical knowledge

**Task 2 Reflection: Digital Portfolio**

For my digital portfolio, I chose to set up profiles on GitHub, Stack Overflow, and Kaggle. I selected GitHub because it is the industry standard for version control and hosting code; over the next four years, I plan to use it to securely store my college assignments and showcase the Python and C++ projects I am building. I created a Stack Overflow account because it is the largest community for developers, and I will rely on it heavily to troubleshoot syntax errors and figure out complex logic. Finally, I chose Kaggle because it is a massive hub for datasets. While I am just starting out, I plan to use Kaggle in the future to pull historical datasets to analyze data trends. Together, these three platforms give me a solid foundation.

**Task 3 Reflection: Coding & Collaboration Platforms**

For Task 3, I explored coding and collaboration platforms by using HackerRank and Google Workspace. On HackerRank, I completed the beginner-level 'Solve Me First' Python challenge. This allowed me to practice basic syntax and understand how automated testing environments evaluate outputs. For the collaboration

aspect, I used Google Forms to build a 5-question 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' covering topics like 2FA and professional email etiquette. I also linked the form to a Google Sheet to automatically collect responses. These tools will be highly beneficial academically to gather survey data for group presentations or track project data efficiently.

**Task 4 Reflection: Digital Communication**

One major problem I have noticed in digital communication is how easily tone can be misinterpreted in text-based messages. For example, during a recent college hackathon, quick, fragmented messages sent in our team group chat came across as overly blunt, leading to a brief moment of unnecessary friction. Because we were rushing to build our project, we lost the polite framing that usually softens face-to-face feedback. This experience highlighted why taking the time to write well-structured, professional emails is crucial when making requests to professors or recruiters. Recognizing the limits of instant messaging and actively choosing the right platform and tone is essential for effective digital collaboration.

**Task 5 Reflection: Cybercrime Awareness**

While researching UPI fraud for Task 5, the thing that surprised me the most was how heavily scammers rely on psychological manipulation rather than advanced hacking. They don't break into your phone; they simply rush you into making a mistake, like entering a UPI PIN under the false belief that it is required to receive money. As a college student who constantly uses UPI for everything from splitting canteen bills to paying for daily expenses, this was an eye-opener. As a result of this research, one habit I will permanently change is how I handle transaction requests. I will no longer approve payment requests or scan QR codes while distracted or on a phone call. I plan to slow down, read the screen prompts carefully, and strictly remember that a PIN is never needed to receive funds.

## Conclusion

Completing this project has significantly broadened my understanding of what it means to be digitally literate. Moving beyond basic tool usage, I have learned the importance of maintaining a professional presence on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn, and the critical need for vigilance against cybercrimes like UPI fraud. These skills are essential for my future career as an engineer. The process of building this portfolio as a Student Digital Ambassador has equipped me with the tools to navigate the digital landscape safely and professionally.

- References


- **Canva:** (canva.com)
- **GitHub:** (github.com)
- **HackerRank:** (hackerrank.com)
- **Google Forms:** (forms.google.com)
- **National Cyber Crime Portal:** (cybercrime.gov.in)